



ZAY-MARIE PRESS

# Seven Day Guided Bible Study Challenge

*A focused study of Philippians 2:1 through 11*

FREE STUDY AND REFERENCE RESOURCE

*Where the Bible Means What It Says*

READ • OBSERVE • INTERPRET • APPLY

## Welcome and Challenge Plan

This seven-day challenge guides you through one complete passage: Philippians 2:1–11. Each day has one focused task that builds toward a concise interpretation and responsible application. You will read the passage repeatedly, observe its structure, follow its context, identify its central claim, and finish with a written study summary.

The goal is not speed or volume. The goal is to practice a disciplined sequence with an open Bible: meaning first, assignment second, application third. Plan for fifteen to twenty minutes each day and preserve your written work so you can see how the evidence strengthens or corrects your first impressions.

| Day | Focus                                | Result                                 |
|-----|--------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|
| 1   | Read the whole passage               | Initial orientation and questions      |
| 2   | Observe words and relationships      | Text based observation record          |
| 3   | Follow the surrounding context       | Contextual boundaries and flow         |
| 4   | Trace the argument                   | Passage structure and central movement |
| 5   | Establish the meaning                | A concise interpretation               |
| 6   | Determine assignment and application | A responsible application              |
| 7   | Review and synthesize                | A completed passage summary            |

Use your preferred Bible translation and write in your own words. Do not consult commentaries until after Day 5. This allows the biblical text and context to shape your initial conclusions before outside explanations are introduced.

## Day 1 Read the Whole Passage

Read Philippians 2:1–11 slowly three times. On the first reading, follow the overall thought. On the second, notice repeated ideas and connecting words. On the third, mark anything that surprises you or raises a question.

### Today's Task

- ☐ Read Philippians 2:1–11 three times.
- ☐ Read Philippians 1:27–30 and 2:12–18 to see what surrounds the passage.
- ☐ Write an initial one-sentence description of what the passage is about.

Initial description:

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Three details I noticed:

1.

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2.

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3.

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Two questions raised by the passage:

1.

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2.

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End-of-day reminder: Your first impression is a starting point, not a final interpretation.

## Day 2 Observe Words and Relationships

Today, record what the passage actually contains before explaining what it means. Pay attention to repetition, commands, descriptions, reasons, contrasts, examples, and changes in subject or action.

### Observation Record

| Feature                          | What I observe in Philippians 2 1 through 11 |
|----------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|
| Repeated words or ideas          |                                              |
| Commands or appeals              |                                              |
| Reasons or supporting statements |                                              |
| Contrasts or comparisons         |                                              |
| Actions attributed to Christ     |                                              |
| Results or outcomes              |                                              |
| Connecting words                 |                                              |

### Observation Check

- ☐ I recorded details before assigning significance.
- ☐ I distinguished the words of the passage from my assumptions.
- ☐ I noted relationships between clauses, not merely isolated terms.

The observation most likely to control the passage:

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## Day 3 Follow the Context

A passage belongs to a developing argument. Read Philippians 1:27–2:18 and identify how 2:1–11 addresses the concerns surrounding it. Notice the repeated emphasis on conduct, unity, striving, humility, obedience, and witness.

### Context Questions

What concern or responsibility appears in Philippians 1:27–30?

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How does Philippians 2:1–4 continue that concern?

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How does Philippians 2:12–18 build on 2:5–11?

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What problem would result from reading 2:5–11 without 2:1–4?

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Context statement: In this section of Philippians, Paul is urging his readers to

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## Day 4 Trace the Argument

Now trace how the passage moves. The goal is not to force every verse into a rigid outline, but to identify the relationships that carry Paul's appeal from instruction through Christ's example to God's exaltation of Christ.

| Verses | Function in the passage                                  | My summary |
|--------|----------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 2:1–2  | Ground and appeal for shared mindedness and unity        |            |
| 2:3–4  | Commands concerning humility and the interests of others |            |
| 2:5    | Connection between the readers' mindset and Christ       |            |
| 2:6–8  | Christ's humility and obedience                          |            |
| 2:9–11 | God's exaltation of Christ and universal acknowledgment  |            |

### Argument in One Movement

Complete this sentence in your own words: Because \_\_\_\_\_, Paul urges the Philippians to \_\_\_\_\_, grounding that appeal in Christ's \_\_\_\_\_, which is followed by God's \_\_\_\_\_.

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The turning point or strongest connection in the passage is:

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## Day 5 Establish the Meaning

Bring the observations and context together. Your interpretation should explain the passage's central communication rather than merely repeat one memorable phrase. It should account for both Paul's appeal to the Philippians and the truths he states about Christ.

### Meaning Builder

The direct audience is:

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The situation or concern addressed is:

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Paul's principal appeal is:

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Christ's example supports the appeal by showing:

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God's response to Christ's humility and obedience establishes:

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### Interpretation Statement

In one paragraph, explain what Philippians 2:1–11 communicates in its context:

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Confidence check: Which part of this interpretation is explicit, and which part is an inference?

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## Day 6 Determine Assignment and Application

The passage was written by Paul to believers in Philippi and supplies governing instruction for their shared life in Christ. Responsible application preserves that meaning and assignment rather than turning Christ's example into an unrelated moral slogan or treating application as a substitute for interpretation.

### Assignment

Who receives the direct appeal in this passage?

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What attitude and conduct does the passage require?

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What truths about Christ support that responsibility?

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### Application

One present relationship or ministry setting in which this truth should govern my conduct:

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One specific act of humility, unity, or concern for another person that follows from the passage:

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One misuse to avoid—for example, an application that ignores the passage's meaning or context:

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## Day 7 Review and Synthesize

Return to your Day 1 description and compare it with the evidence gathered during the week. Revise rather than defend an early impression. A strong summary should be concise enough to remember and specific enough to show how the passage supports it.

### Final Review

- ☐ My interpretation accounts for Philippians 2:1–4 and 2:5–11 together.
- ☐ I used the surrounding context of Philippians 1:27–2:18.
- ☐ I distinguished observation from inference.
- ☐ I can show which features of the passage support my central conclusion.
- ☐ I established meaning before application.
- ☐ My application preserves the passage's direct assignment and purpose.
- ☐ I corrected at least one weak, incomplete, or unsupported first impression.

My revised one-sentence description of the passage:

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The most important correction or clarification I made this week:

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The interpretive habit I most need to continue practicing:

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## Completed Passage Study Summary

Passage studied: Philippians 2:1–11

Central subject:

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Meaning in context:

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Strongest supporting evidence:

1.

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2.

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3.

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Direct assignment:

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Responsible application:

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Interpretive boundary—what the passage does not establish by itself:

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## Continue Building the Habit

You have completed a bounded passage study by moving from repeated reading through observation, context, structure, meaning, assignment, application, and review. Repeat the same seven-day rhythm with another complete paragraph, adjusting the questions when the literary form or subject requires it.

### Suggested Next Passages

| Passage                 | Study emphasis                                                                       |
|-------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ephesians 2:1–10        | Follow the movement from former condition to salvation and purpose.                  |
| Colossians 3:1–17       | Trace identity, mindset, conduct, and community responsibilities.                    |
| Romans 12:1–8           | Follow the relationship among consecration, renewed thinking, humility, and service. |
| 1 Thessalonians 4:13–18 | Identify the pastoral concern, revealed explanation, and intended comfort.           |

### Scope and Next Level

This challenge provides one guided introductory study. It does not teach the complete interpretive method, literary and historical analysis, doctrinal synthesis, programmatic diagnostics, advanced research controls, cumulative exercises, guided exegesis, or independent capstone work included in the Biblical Hermeneutics Course.

For a reusable blank process, use the free Passage Study Worksheet Pack. For sequenced training toward independent competence, continue with the Biblical Hermeneutics Course.

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